WRITING



Paragraph Writing

A paragraph discusses one idea in detail and aids the development of an overall topic for the essay. Paragraph length will vary depending on the purpose of the paragraph.

Parts of a Paragraph

The basic paragraph consists of three parts:

1. A Topic sentence, 2. Supporting details, 3. A Concluding sentence

Topic Sentence

The main idea of each paragraph is stated in a topic sentence. Generally, the topic sentence is the first sentence of a paragraph. All subsequent points made in the paragraphs should support the topic sentence.

Supporting Details

Supporting details elaborate upon and prove the topic sentence. Supporting details should be drawn from a variety of sources. The following are common sources of supporting details:

- ✓ Expert Opinion
- ✓ Brief Stories
- ✓ Facts and Statistics
- ✓ Research Studies
- ✓ Personal Experiences
- ✓ Interviews

Concluding Sentence

Each paragraph should end with a concluding sentence that ties together the ideas brought up in the paragraph and emphasizes the main idea one last time.

A model paragraph is given below:

An Unconventional Pianist

Glenn Gould is widely regarded as Canada's most famous and eccentric pianist. He is renowned for his recordings of the music of Johann Sebastian Bach. For example, Bach's Goldberg Variations, Gould's first recording, was among the best-selling classical music albums of its time. Gould is also famous for his unusual behaviour. He would only play concerts while sitting on an old chair his father had made, and he usually hummed while he played. Contrary to most pianists, he disliked playing in concert halls, and devoted most of his career to the recording studio until his death in 1982. In brief, Glenn Gould was an unconventional pianist who made a significant impact on the world of music.

Topic Sentence ■ Supporting Detail #1 ■ Supporting Detail #2 ■ Concluding Sentence ■

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